

MAVERICK BUSINESS ACADEMY

US / UK Immigration FAQ Report

Girne American University & Rushford Business School
Qualification recognition, route requirements and sources

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Updated 9 September 2026

1. Overview

Completing a programme does not, on its own, establish US or UK immigration eligibility. A graduate may qualify through an applicable route if all of its requirements are met. Academic recognition, a visa, post-study work permission and permanent residence are separate matters.

This report explains general US and UK requirements relevant to qualifications from Girne American University and Rushford Business School. It covers the exact award, study arrangements and individual evidence required by the chosen route, without certifying any qualification or applicant as eligible.

2. Frequently asked questions

Rushford Business School (RBS)

Q. Does completing a Rushford Business School programme make me eligible to migrate to the US or UK?

No, not from programme completion alone. A Rushford qualification does not itself establish eligibility for a US or UK visa or permanent residence. Graduates may qualify through a separate route if they meet all its requirements. Where academic evidence is required, acceptance of the exact award must be established; provider certification or a partner award is not immigration approval.

The **UK Graduate route** requires eligible study, the relevant Student permission and compliance with UK-study requirements. **US Optional Practical Training (OPT)** is linked to F-1 status and qualifying study. An overseas or online programme alone does not establish entitlement to either post-study work option. Work and permanent-residence routes have separate requirements, which may include qualifying employment, accepted qualifications or other prescribed evidence.

If migration is your goal, seek appropriately qualified immigration advice on your individual circumstances and the current rules before choosing a programme.

Immigration and residency decisions rest solely with the relevant authorities. This information is general guidance, not immigration advice.

Girne American University (GAU)

Q. Does completing a Girne American University programme make me eligible to migrate to the US or UK?

Completing a GAU programme does not, by itself, establish US or UK immigration eligibility. A graduate may qualify for a visa or permanent residence through an applicable route, but must meet that route's conditions. Any required assessment must relate to the exact qualification; academic recognition or a study-transfer arrangement is not immigration permission.

For the **UK**, sponsored work and the Graduate route have different requirements; the latter requires eligible study, the relevant Student permission and compliance with UK-study requirements. For the **US**, work and residence routes require their own evidence, while **Optional Practical Training (OPT)** is linked to F-1 status and qualifying study. An overseas or online programme alone does not establish these post-study work entitlements.

Before relying on a programme for migration plans, have the current route requirements, award details and your individual circumstances reviewed by an appropriately qualified immigration adviser.

Immigration and residency decisions rest solely with the relevant authorities. This information is general guidance, not immigration advice.

3. Evidence and interpretation

Primary immigration sources and contextual evidence rechecked on 9 September 2026. This is a summary, not a complete visa checklist or an individual assessment.

UK: Graduate route is not an automatic benefit of an overseas award

The official guidance requires an eligible course studied with the relevant Student or Tier 4 permission, a qualifying licensed education provider and compliance with the UK-study requirement. Applying also requires being in the UK. A UK partner's name on a qualification or an online programme completed overseas does not, by itself, establish this eligibility.

What this means. An overseas or online award alone does not establish Graduate-route eligibility. Historical distance-learning concessions and any qualifying study arrangements must be assessed under the applicable rules; this is not a bar on every online graduate applying through a different visa route.

Sources: [1]

UK: Skilled Worker eligibility depends on a sponsored job and other conditions

The Skilled Worker route requires an approved employer, a certificate of sponsorship, an eligible occupation, the applicable salary and other requirements, including English-language evidence where required. A degree or institution name alone is not enough.

What this means. The sponsored job and the applicable immigration conditions determine eligibility. Holding a degree, choosing a university or completing a particular programme does not replace those requirements.

Sources: [2]

UK: the HPI university list is specific to the qualification award period

Neither Girne American University nor Rushford Business School appears on the official list for qualifications awarded from 1 November 2025 to 31 October 2026. HPI requires the correct awarding institution on the list for the month and year of the award, an eligible qualification and other conditions. Ecctis assesses qualification validity and level; it does not check university-list eligibility.

What this means. The list finding applies only to the stated qualification award period, not to every visa route or every past/future award. A partner-issued qualification requires its own awarding-institution check. The applicable list must match the month and year of the qualification award.

Sources: [3] [4]

US: H-1B specialty employment and academic evidence are separate tests

For H-1B specialty occupations, the position must meet the specialty-occupation criteria and the individual must meet the qualification requirements. A relevant foreign degree equivalent to the required US degree can be one route; the rules also recognise specified alternative evidence. Employer or agent petitioning and other immigration requirements apply.

What this means. The position, the exact qualification or permitted alternative evidence, relevance to the role and any professional authorisation must be assessed individually. A credential evaluation is evidence, not a visa decision.

Sources: [5]

US: OPT is linked to F-1 status and qualifying study

USCIS describes OPT as practical training for eligible F-1 students with qualifying study at an SEVP-certified institution, subject to the applicable study, recommendation and employment-authorisation requirements. Authorised study-abroad periods can count in specified circumstances; an overseas or online qualification alone does not create OPT entitlement.

What this means. OPT depends on F-1 status and qualifying study, including the applicable treatment of authorised study-abroad periods. It is not permanent residence and is not an automatic benefit of an overseas degree.

Sources: [6]

US: an advanced degree alone does not establish a Green Card entitlement

EB-2 has advanced-degree and exceptional-ability eligibility provisions. Under the advanced-degree branch, the relevant US degree or foreign equivalent, or a qualifying bachelor's degree plus at least five years of progressive post-bachelor's specialty experience, is only part of the assessment. Job-offer and labour-certification requirements generally apply, subject to exceptions. A national interest waiver has additional requirements and is not granted merely for holding an MBA or doctorate.

What this means. An advanced degree does not satisfy every EB-2 or national-interest-waiver condition. NIW may permit self-petitioning without an employer sponsor, but its separate eligibility and waiver requirements still apply.

Sources: [7]

Provider-specific evidence: academic transfer and certification are not immigration approval

GAU's cited transfer announcement concerns the 2014-2015 academic year and a 2014 application deadline; it does not prove a current Maverick US/UK pathway. Rushford lists eduQwa certification for its online division. eduQwa explicitly states that it certifies continuing-education institutions, not individual courses, degrees or persons.

What this means. Academic transfer, institutional certification, memberships, credit totals and partner names do not establish immigration eligibility. Acceptance of an individual GAU or RBS award must be assessed for its intended use; neither universal acceptance nor universal rejection is established here.

Sources: [8] [9] [10]

4. Application across programmes

The common clarification covers 9 programme categories and 84 programme-list entries. This does not certify the availability, recognition or immigration acceptance of every award.

Provider	Programme categories	How the FAQ applies
Rushford Business School	BBA, MBA, MSc and doctoral research	The general clarification applies across these four programme categories. Each award, study route and intended immigration use requires its own assessment; qualification labels are not interchangeable.
Girne American University	BSc, MBA, EMBA, thesis-based master's and PhD	The general clarification applies across these five programme categories. Exact award titles, study arrangements and recognition requirements must be checked for the selected programme.

No particular visa route, credential equivalence or sponsored transfer has been established for all these programmes. Current requirements need individual assessment.

5. FAQ claim-to-source mapping

Programme completion alone does not establish immigration eligibility; an individual must qualify under an applicable route.

Sources: [1] [2] [3] [5] [6] [7]

Where academic evidence is required, the exact award and route-specific qualification requirements matter.

Sources: [3] [5] [7]

An overseas or online programme alone does not create UK Graduate-route or US OPT entitlement.

Sources: [1] [6]

Academic recognition, a transfer arrangement, certification or a partner award is not itself immigration permission.

Sources: [1] [2] [3] [5] [6] [7] [8] [9] [10]

Work and permanent-residence routes have separate conditions; neither graduate eligibility nor degree equivalence is certified by this report.

Sources: [2] [5] [7]

6. Source register

Every link below is clickable and its full URL is shown. The review date records when the source was checked, not a new publication date or a guarantee of future rules.

[1] Graduate visa: the course you studied

GOV.UK - UK Visas and Immigration | Government eligibility guidance | Checked: 2026-09-09

<https://www.gov.uk/graduate-visa/course-you-studied>

Scope and limit. Eligible course and provider, Student permission, UK-study requirement, application location and historical distance-learning concessions. Not an approval of any GAU/RBS award.

[2] Skilled Worker visa: overview

GOV.UK - UK Visas and Immigration | Government eligibility guidance | Checked: 2026-09-09

<https://www.gov.uk/skilled-worker-visa>

Scope and limit. Sponsorship, job, salary, language and other conditions. No finding on a specific applicant's job or qualifications.

[3] High Potential Individual visa: eligibility

GOV.UK - UK Visas and Immigration | Government eligibility guidance | Checked: 2026-09-09

<https://www.gov.uk/high-potential-individual-visa/eligibility>

Scope and limit. Award-period university list, qualification level/recency, Ecctis assessment and other requirements. Ecctis does not check whether the university is on the list.

[4] HPI global universities list 2025

GOV.UK - UK Visas and Immigration | Government award-period list | Checked: 2026-09-09

<https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/high-potential-individual-visa-global-universities-list/high-potential-individual-visa-global-universities-list-2025>

Scope and limit. Qualifications awarded 1 November 2025-31 October 2026 only. Full displayed list reviewed; neither GAU nor RBS appears. No conclusion about all other periods or a separately awarded partner qualification.

[5] H-1B specialty occupations

US Citizenship and Immigration Services (USCIS) | Government eligibility guidance | Checked: 2026-09-09

<https://www.uscis.gov/working-in-the-united-states/h-1b-specialty-occupations>

Scope and limit. Specialty occupation, relevant degree/equivalent or permitted alternatives, petition process and professional licensing. No fee, cap availability or individual equivalence claim is made in the FAQ.

[6] Policy Manual, Volume 2, Part F, Chapter 5 - Practical Training

US Citizenship and Immigration Services (USCIS) | Government policy manual | Checked: 2026-09-09

<https://www.uscis.gov/policy-manual/volume-2-part-f-chapter-5>

Scope and limit. F-1 practical training and qualifying study, SEVP institutions, OPT recommendation/authorisation and defined study-abroad treatment. Not a general work visa for holders of foreign degrees.

[7] Employment-Based Immigration: Second Preference EB-2

US Citizenship and Immigration Services (USCIS) | Government eligibility guidance | Checked: 2026-09-09

<https://www.uscis.gov/working-in-the-united-states/permanent-workers/employment-based-immigration-second-preference-eb-2>

Scope and limit. Advanced-degree/exceptional-ability provisions, job-offer and labour-certification rules, and NIW conditions/self-petitioning. A degree alone does not satisfy the full requirements.

[8] Undergraduate transfer quotas for inter-continental higher education

Girne American University | Historical provider announcement - 2014-2015 | Checked: 2026-09-09

https://www.gau.edu.tr/en/haber/892/gau_announced_the_undergraduate_transfer_quotas_for_inter-continental_higher_education

Scope and limit. Academic transfer context only. The text specifies a 29 August 2014 deadline. It is not proof of current campus, sponsor, partnership, visa or migration availability.

[9] Accreditations and Collaborations

Rushford Business School | Provider description | Checked: 2026-09-09

<https://rushford.ch/accreditations/>

Scope and limit. Rushford's description of online-division certification, memberships and collaborations. Not a government immigration or credential-equivalence decision.

[10] eduQua - the quality label for continuing education and training

Swiss Federation for Adult Learning (SVEB), eduQua scheme owner | Certification-scheme owner guidance | Checked: 2026-09-09

<https://alice.ch/en/eduqua/>

Scope and limit. Explicitly states that certification concerns institutions, not individual courses, degrees or persons, and does not accredit or verify qualifications.

7. Scope and limitations

- The information does not establish a university-provided migration entitlement, universal degree equivalence, or a guaranteed visa, job, permanent residence or citizenship outcome.
- Graduates are not automatically excluded from every immigration route. Eligibility depends on the route and individual evidence.
- No individual credential-equivalence assessment or immigration application has been determined by this report.
- The historical GAU announcement does not establish a current sponsored transfer pathway. Obtain current programme and sponsor evidence for any proposed transfer.
- Visa fees, salary thresholds, processing times and other requirements can change. Consult the current official guidance for the intended application.
- This is general information, not a complete visa checklist or individual immigration advice. Seek appropriately qualified advice before relying on a programme for a migration plan.

Immigration and residency decisions rest solely with the relevant authorities. This information is general guidance, not immigration advice.